

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -  
♥ 9 6  
♦ K Q J 10 8 7  
♣ Q J 9 7 2

♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

4 ♥

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North  
to your advantage.

When the bidding gets high in a hurry you sometimes have to guess what you can make. North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♥ K.

And it looks like you are too high. Assuming the trumps split 2-1, you still have one ♥ loser, two ♦ losers and one ♣ loser.

You win the ♥ A and play a ♠ to your ♠ K. West discards a ♦!

From bad to worse. Now you must add a ♠ loser to the four you already had. Are you finished?

No, never give up. East has a bunch of ♥s and 3 ♠s, so he cannot have many ♦s and ♣s. If you can eliminate those and then throw him in it should work

Play your ♠ A, the ♦ A and the ♣ A K. East follows to everything.

You've done all you can do. Now play the ♥ 10 to East's high ♥.

East has just won his side's first trick with the ♥ J. He now plays the ♠ Q, winning his side's second trick.

Now, East is still on lead, and he has nothing in his hand but good ♥s. So he leads one of them, and you **DO NOT RUFF**. Instead you discard a ♣ from dummy and a ♦ from your own hand. East has now taken his side's third trick. He plays another good ♥, and you ruff in dummy and discard the last ♦ loser from your hand. You can now cross-ruff for the rest of the tricks.

Incredible isn't it.

You just wonder how many bridge players would have just conceded down 2 on this hand.

Not you or me, of course.

**Board 3**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6  
 ♥ K 8 2  
 ♦ K Q 10 3 2  
 ♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3  
 ♥ 7 5 4  
 ♦ A J 6  
 ♣ Q 7 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 8 5  
 ♥ J 10 9 6  
 ♦ 9 8 7 4  
 ♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2  
 ♥ A Q 3  
 ♦ 5  
 ♣ A K 3

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       | Pass | 1 ♠   |
| Pass     | 3 ♠   | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass     | 5 ♥   | Pass | 6 ♠   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

6 ♠ by South

small ♥ from your hand. West wins his ♦ Q (which his opening lead told you he held) and is end-played. He must lead a ♥ to your tenace or give you a ruff-sluff.

The answer to the question posed above is:

It is a pretty simple problem, but you are no doubt getting a lot better.

North's 3 ♠ is a limit raise, 11-12 points in support of ♠s. When you discover that the raise includes two Aces you bid the slam. South plays 6 ♠. West leads the ♦ K, won by you with dummy's ♦ A.

Is this a really easy elimination play showing up this late in the group? Or are you just getting better at seeing them? In any case, you should see that a successful ♥ finesse will land your contract, but you should also remember that there aren't many finesses working on these 25 deals.

So rather than finesse, eliminate! Pull trumps in two rounds, ending in dummy.

Ruff the ♦ 6, then play ♣ A, ♣ K, ♣ Q.

So here you are in dummy. Do you finesse the ♥ now? Of course not. You play the ♦ J and discard a